

screenshot. Normalising a track in Audacity automatically sets the highest peak to -3 dB. This ensures that there's no jarring and distortion even at the loudest part of the song—the highest amplitude.

Click anywhere in the waveform and press [Ctrl] + [A] to select the whole song. Now go to Effects > Normalize..., and click Preview if you want to hear a few seconds of the normalised track, or just click OK to Normalize. You will see a smaller waveform, with lower peaks, and you will now not find distortion at higher volumes.

The greatest advantage of the normalising effect is that it can be applied in batches (in the editors that support batch processing), so your music collection will have a consistent volume throughout. It's a standard feature in nearly any application that has anything to do with audio—you might have noticed the "Normalize All Tracks" option even when creating an audio CD using Nero.

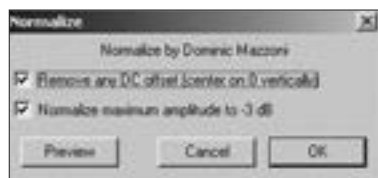
Normalising music files as a group works in the same way as Normalise, only the peak of the wave is calculated by analysing the loudness of all the waveforms rather than fixing it to an arbitrary



Opening a song in Audacity will show you its waveform



Select Normalize from the Effects menu to prevent distortion



Just click OK to normalise, or click Preview to hear a few seconds of the normalised track